TIP You can disable all the automatic features enabled by the `[ApiController]` attribute, but I encourage you to stick to the defaults unless you really need to change them. You can read more about disabling features in the documentation at https://docs.microsoft.com/aspnet/core/web-api.

The ability to customize each aspect of your web API controllers is one of the key differentiators with minimal APIs. In the next section you'll learn how to control the format of the data returned by your web API controllers—whether that's JSON, XML, or a different, custom format.

20.5 Generating a response from a model

This brings us to the final topic in this chapter: formatting a response. It's common for API controllers to return JSON these days, but that's not always the case. In this section you'll learn about content negotiation and how to enable additional output formats such as XML.

Consider this scenario: you've created a web API action method for returning a list of cars, as in the following listing. It invokes a method on your application model, which hands back the list of data to the controller. Now you need to format the response and return it to the caller.

Listing 20.13 A web API controller to return a list of cars

```
[ApiController]
public class CarsController : Controller
{
    [HttpGet("api/cars")]                          ❶
    public IEnumerable<string> ListCars()          ❷
    {
        return new string[]                        ❸
            { "Nissan Micra", "Ford Focus" };      ❸
```